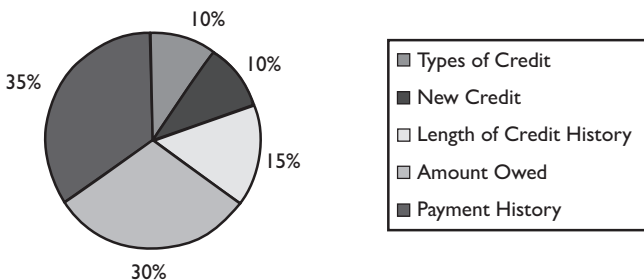


credit. Therefore, he would eventually create a brand new credit history in his name.

This tactic succeeded in getting him several credit cards, and soon he was even successful in getting a loan for a used car. Trent would have probably continued on with this new identity if the Federal Trade Commission (FTC), who had been compiling evidence against the credit repair firm, had not discovered Trent as one of its customers.

Trent thought that he had found the perfect solution, but had no idea it was illegal. He was falsifying his social security number and living under an assumed number. In fact, Trent learned all this when the FTC and the Attorney General's office contacted him after they closed down the fraudulent credit repair company. Trent lost the money he had paid to repair his credit in addition to being a party to an illegal enterprise. Now not only did he have credit problems, but legal ones as well.

If Trent had learned the art of patience, he would have eventually recovered from his negative credit history. True, seven years is a long time for negative credit to stay on a credit report, but many creditors look closely only at the most recent two years. Trent should have concentrated on improving his credit history. As the chart below illustrates, the most heavily weighted factor in determining a credit score is one's payment history (comprising 35 percent of the score).



Source: "Your Credit Scores," Consumer Federation of America and Fair Isaac®

